



Welded armor

△ Char léger Modèle 1936 FCM

Date 1936 **Country** France

Weight 13.7 tons (12.4 tonnes)

Engine Berliet 4-cylinder diesel, 91hp

Main armament 37 mm Puteaux SA 18 L/21 gun

This two-man infantry tank, commonly known as the FCM 36, was one of the first tanks to use welded armor, which gave it excellent protection. However, its SA 18 gun was inadequate against enemy armor, making the FCM less useful against the German Panzer forces. Only 100 were produced.



Cast turret

Front-mounted drive sprocket

△ Char léger Modèle 1939 H

Date 1935 **Country** France

Weight 13.2 tons (12 tonnes)

Engine Hotchkiss 6-cylinder gasoline, 120hp

Main armament 37 mm Puteaux SA 38 L/33 gun

The H39 was an upgraded version of the H35, a two-man light tank. Intended to operate with the infantry, the H35 was rejected because of its poor cross-country performance and was passed to the cavalry. The H39 solved this problem and improved the tank's firepower. Around 1,200 tanks of both versions were built in total. After the fall of France in 1940, several hundred of these were used by the Germans.



One-man turret

47 mm antitank gun

Metal tracks



△ A9 Cruiser

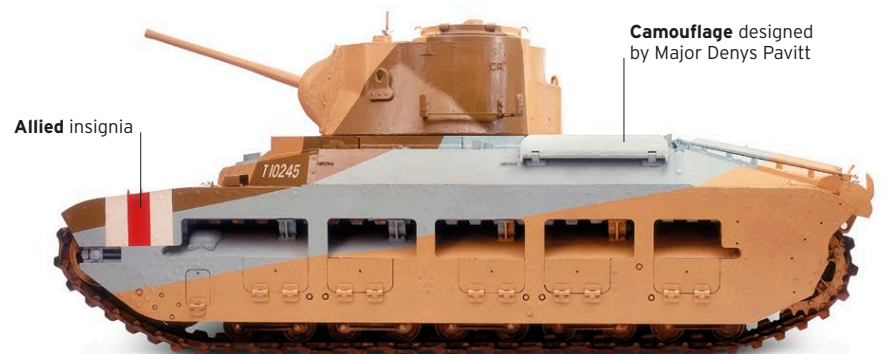
Date 1937 **Country** UK

Weight 13.4 tons (12.2 tonnes)

Engine AEC Type 179 gasoline, 150 hp

Main armament QF 2-pounder gun

The A9 was the first cruiser tank, a British concept intended for independent operations rather than infantry support. It was therefore fast, but lightly armored. The A9 had capable suspension and probably the most powerful antitank gun in the world at the time—the 2-pounder.



Allied insignia

Camouflage designed by Major Denys Pavitt

△ Infantry Tank Mark IIA A12

Date 1939 **Country** UK

Weight 29.7 tons (26.9 tonnes)

Engine 2 x AEC 6-cylinder diesel, 95 hp each

Main armament QF 2-pounder gun

Commonly known as Matilda II, this infantry tank was a far more capable vehicle than its predecessor. It had even heavier armor and a 2-pounder gun. In late 1940 and early 1941, this "Queen of the Desert" dominated the battlefields of North Africa. Although outclassed by later German tanks, it fought on in Australian hands against the Japanese. It was the only British tank to serve throughout World War II.

▽ A13 Cruiser Mark III

Date 1939 **Country** UK

Weight 15.9 tons (14.4 tonnes)

Engine Nuffield Liberty V12 gasoline, 240 hp

Main armament QF 2-pounder gun

The Mark III A13 was the first British tank to use Christie suspension (see pp.52-53). This and the Mark III's powerful engine gave it greater mobility, but its armor was only 0.55 in (14 mm) at its thickest. The Mark III—and the better-armored but otherwise identical Mark IV—served in France in 1940 and the Western Desert in 1941.



Crew kit on turret